VIDEO GAME CREATION

Lesson 8 - Core Mechanics II: Under Pressure

Semester 1, Week 8 - Lose Condition + Lives System

- **Objectives:** Reuse an existing code path (Lesson 7's escape cleanup) to drive a new, independent piece of game state; implement a lives counter and a lose condition; explain why the lose message doesn't yet stop or reset the game, and why that's a deliberate, temporary choice.
- **IGDA Tie-In:** Programming - state tracking, win/lose conditions, event-driven programming (intermediate); Production - deliberate feature sequencing / incremental scope
- **Featured Engine (lecture demo):** Unity (C#)
- **Materials:** Demo laptop with all 8 engines verified (see Teacher's Checklist); Student Handouts, one per engine; students' own Lesson 7 projects (already saved); three placeholder sound effects in this lesson's Assets/ folder (sfx_lifelost.wav, sfx_gameover.wav, sfx_start.wav) for the Level 3 sound idea - the core exercise itself needs no new assets

Agenda

0:00-0:05	Welcome back, Lesson 7 recap
0:05-0:15	Reversing the Question: What Happens When THEY Reach YOU?
0:15-0:35	Reusing What You Built: The Escape Path Gets Stakes (live demo in Unity)
0:35-0:50	Two Counters, Never Crossed: Keeping Lives and Kills Independent
0:50-0:55	Why We're Not Building Game Over (Yet)
0:55-1:00	Introduce lab exercise, hand out engine-specific handouts
1:00-1:50	LAB: Add a lives system and lose condition to your project
1:50-2:00	Exit check / quick share-out

Levels for this lesson's exercise

- Level 1 (Minimal): every enemy that reaches the bottom unshot costs a life, tracked starting at 3; "Game Over" appears the instant lives reach zero.
- Level 2 (Complete): shooting an enemy never costs a life, and letting one escape never counts as a kill - the two counters stay fully independent.
- Level 3 (Refined): add a live lives readout and/or a lose sound, and tighten the separation between escape/lives code and hit-detection/win code.

See: Lesson 8 Teacher's Script, Lesson 8 Prep Checklist, and the per-engine Student Handouts. No engine-specific bugfix this week - every engine's Lesson 7 structure already supports this cleanly.